



Social Content-Sharing iOS App
iOS Development · Swift · SwiftUI · UIKit · Firebase

Live on App Store

About the App

Cl:k is a social content-sharing platform for iOS, live on the App Store. The app lets users share stories with two distinct tiers — VIP and Circle — control who sees their content, send messages with rich media, and stay connected with friends. I joined the project as a freelance iOS developer and contributed across the entire codebase, from UI polish and new features to crash fixes and performance improvements.

The app is built in Swift with UIKit, uses a REST API via Alamofire, Firebase Cloud Messaging for push notifications, AdMob for monetisation, GIPHY for GIF support, SDWebImage for image/GIF rendering, and an iOS Share Extension for cross-app content sharing.

Swift	UIKit	Alamofire	Firebase FCM
AdMob	SDWebImage	GIPHY SDK	LinkPresentation
App Groups	Share Extension	AVFoundation	

Work Done

I worked on 45 tracked tasks across the project, covering feature development, UI improvements, bug fixes, and performance work. Below is a summary of the key areas.

1. Circle Space UI Card Redesign

Redesigned the story list UI so Circle story cells are fully circular (not rounded-rect) with a double border ring — teal gradient for unwatched stories, grey when all watched, and no border when a friend has no story. VIP story items were left visually unchanged. Implemented screen-height-based sizing constants so the layout scales correctly across all device sizes.

2. Message URL Link Preview

Built a link preview card that appears inside message bubbles when the message text contains a URL. Used Apple's LinkPresentation framework to fetch OG metadata (title, thumbnail, domain) asynchronously. Implemented a two-layer cache (NSCache + disk) so previews persist across cold launches and scrolling never re-fetches. Handled cell reuse correctly to prevent stale previews appearing on recycled cells.

3. GIF Support in Comments

Integrated the GIPHY SDK to let users pick and send animated GIFs in the comment section. GIFs are downloaded from the GIPHY CDN and uploaded to the backend via multipart POST. Added SDAnimatedImageView to comment cells with dynamic height calculation from each GIF's aspect ratio, and a static height cache so cells never jump when scrolled back into view.

4. Share Extension Token Refresh

Fixed a 401 Unauthorized error in the iOS Share Extension that occurred when the access token expired and the user hadn't opened the main app. Implemented silent token refresh in the Share Extension using shared App Group storage, with automatic retry of the failed request after refresh. Both the main app and the extension now always read the latest token from shared storage.

5. Audio Recording in Chat

Built MVP voice note recording directly inside the message conversation screen. Users can record, preview, and send audio messages. Implemented AVAudioSession management and handled the iOS 15 "Could not start an audio session" error with a proper session activation fallback.

6. Voice Note UI — Sent vs Received

Updated the voice note UI to visually differentiate sent and received voice messages, matching the distinct bubble styling of regular text messages. Both sides now have their own layout and color treatment.

7. Message Conversation Header Redesign

Replaced the plain navigation bar title in the message conversation screen with a card-style header showing the friend's profile picture, name, and a tappable area that navigates to their full profile. Also added a fullscreen viewer that opens when tapping a friend's display picture.

8. Story Features and Bug Fixes

Worked on multiple story-related tasks: loading timeout and retry for the story player (CIS-751), correct space theme when opening a story from a push notification (CIS-913), story progress bar display via notifications (CIS-917), story caption overlapping the header (CIS-968/993), handling audio playback in silent mode (CIS-940), and fixing overlapping toast messages on story reply (CIS-942).

9. Notification and Badge System

Implemented real-time notification bell updates via socket events, unread count badges on the Messages tab, story thumbnail display on the notification screen, and hiding story-related notifications older than 24 hours. Also suppressed a spurious "invalid access token" error that was appearing on the front end incorrectly.

10. Comment Enhancements

Added comment count indicators on story previews, mention indicators on the comment screen, GIF icon size fix, and improved the caption text field with multi-line support and enhanced styling. Fixed the textBio cursor overflowing its bordered area on multiline input.

11. Onboarding — Add/Invite Friends Screen

Built a new onboarding screen that appears after profile setup, prompting users to add or invite friends. The Add to VIP and Add to Circle cards continue to display until the user reaches their friend limit, improving discoverability for new users.

12. Media Download to Gallery

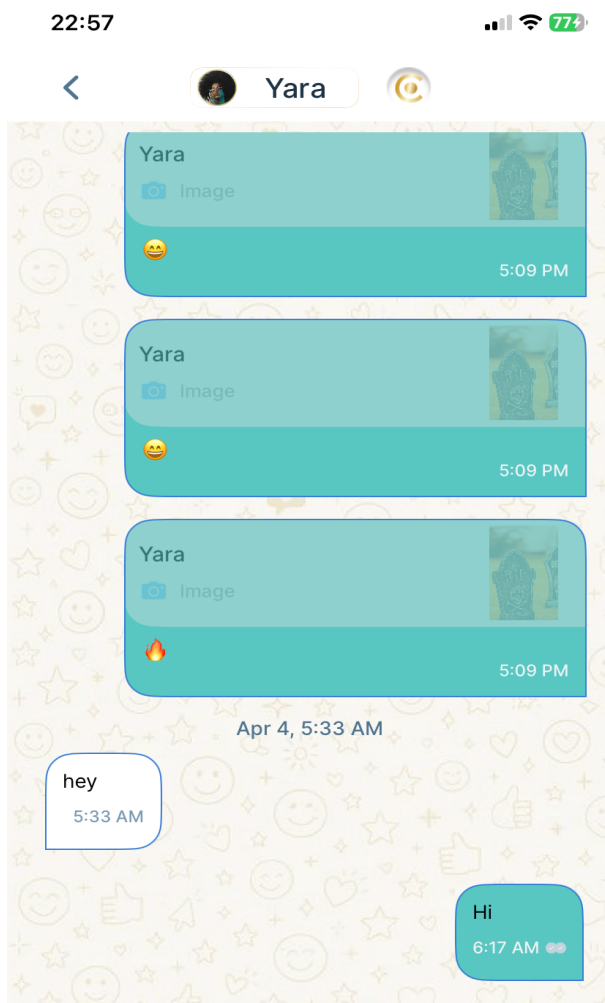
Changed the behaviour for downloading media so that files are saved directly to the iPhone's Photos gallery instead of the Files app, matching user expectations for a social media app.

App Screenshots

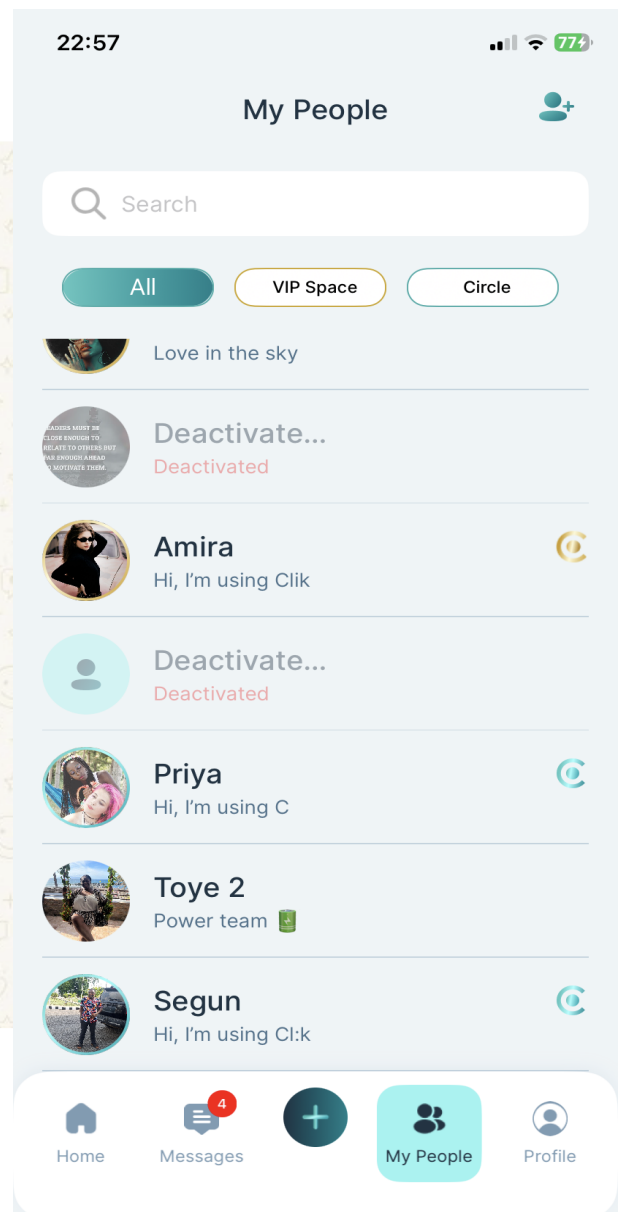


Home — VIP & Circle Stories

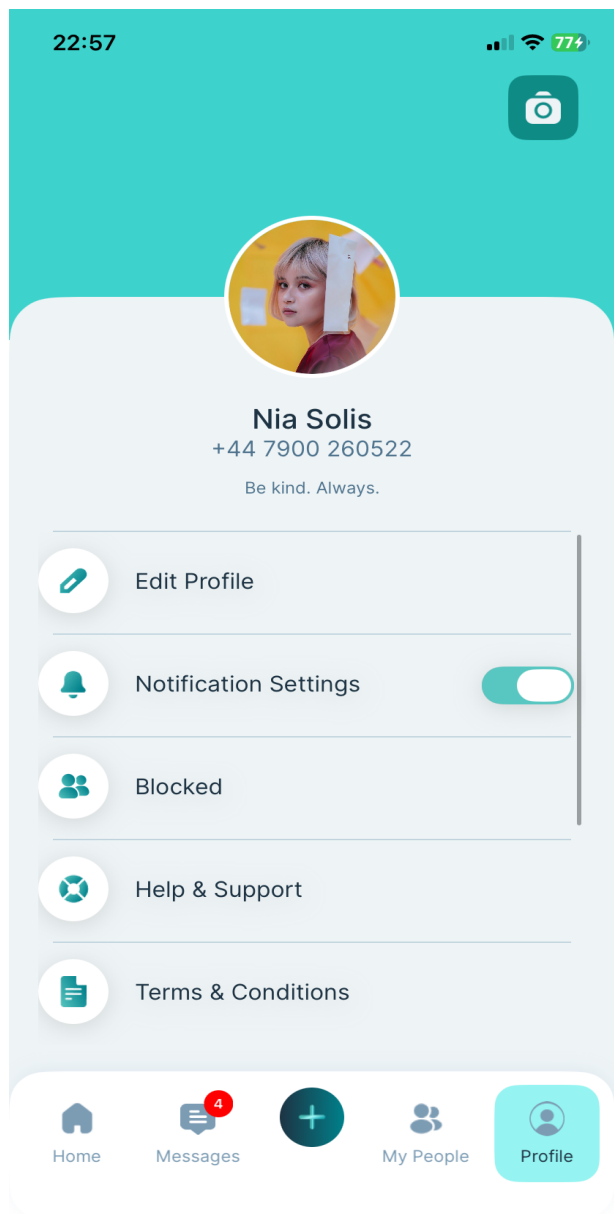
Messages List



Chat Conversation



My People



Profile